MYDFIR SOC INVESTIGATION REPORT

The Planet's Prestige – Email Forensics Investigation

Investigation Type: Phishing / Suspicious Email Analysis

Analyst: Tayo Porsche

Investigation Date: 1 November 2026

Environment: Isolated SOC Lab – Ubuntu

Case Status: Investigation completed

1. Findings

The investigation identified the following findings:

* Email Subject: A Hope to CoCanDa
* Displayed Sender: Bill
* Sender Address: billjobs@microapple.com
* Email Service Used: emkei.cz
* Reply-To Address: negeja3921@pashter.com
* SPF Result: Fail
* Sending IP Address: 93.99.104.210
* Attachment Name: PuzzleToCoCanDa.pdf
* Actual Attachment File Type: ZIP archive (.zip)
* Suspected Actor: Pestero Negeja
* Scenario Location: The Martian Colony, Beside Interplanetary Spaceport
* Probable Command-and-Control (C&C) Domain: pashter.com

The attachment used a misleading PDF filename. Its file signature began with 50 4B 03 04, which identifies a ZIP archive.

The extracted files included:

* DaughtersCrown – JPEG image

* GoodJobMajor – PDF document

* Money.xlsx – Excel workbook

The PDF metadata identified Pestero Negeja as its author. The Excel workbook contained Base64-encoded information that revealed the scenario location.

2. Investigation Summary

An email titled “A Hope to CoCanDa” was investigated due to suspicious characteristics.

Email header analysis revealed that the displayed sender address was billjobs@microapple.com, while the Reply-To address was negeja3921@pashter.com.

The email was received through emkei.cz, an email spoofing service. SPF authentication failed for the claimed sender domain, indicating that the sending IP address was not authorised to send email on behalf of that domain.

The email contained an attachment named PuzzleToCoCanDa.pdf. Although the filename and MIME information presented it as a PDF, file-signature analysis confirmed that the attachment was actually a ZIP archive.

The archive was extracted in the isolated investigation environment. Its contents were examined, including a PDF document, a JPEG image and an Excel workbook.

Metadata from the PDF identified Pestero Negeja. Further examination of the Excel workbook revealed Base64-encoded text identifying the location as:

The Martian Colony, Beside Interplanetary Spaceport.

The investigation also identified pashter.com as the probable C&C domain based on the Reply-To address and the challenge evidence.

3. Who, What, When, Where, Why and How

WHO – Who was involved?

* Displayed sender: Bill

* Claimed sender address: billjobs@microapple.com

* Reply-To address: negeja3921@pashter.com

* Suspected actor identified in the evidence: Pestero Negeja

WHAT – What happened?

A suspicious email titled “A Hope to CoCanDa” was sent with an attachment disguised as a PDF document.

The attachment was actually a ZIP archive containing three extracted files. Analysis of the files revealed information identifying the suspected actor, the scenario location and a probable C&C domain.

WHEN – When did this occur?

The email header recorded the following date and time:

26 January 2021, 01:41:18 -0500 (EST)

Equivalent UTC time: 26 January 2021, 06:41:18 UTC.

The available evidence does not establish whether any subsequent activity remained ongoing.

WHERE – Where did this happen?

The email passed through emkei.cz, with the recorded sending IP address 93.99.104.210.

The scenario location identified in the Excel workbook was:

The Martian Colony, Beside Interplanetary Spaceport.

This is the location stated in the challenge evidence, not a verified real-world geolocation.

WHY – Why did this happen?

The evidence suggests an attempt to deceive the recipient using a misleading sender identity and a disguised attachment.

The exact motive cannot be independently established beyond the information contained in the challenge artefacts.

HOW – How did this happen?

The email was sent through emkei.cz using a claimed sender identity.

The Reply-To address directed responses to negeja3921@pashter.com. SPF authentication failed.

The attachment was disguised with a PDF filename but contained ZIP archive data.

Extracted documents and workbook contents provided additional clues that identified the suspected actor and scenario location.

4. Recommendations

1. Treat emails with failed SPF authentication and mismatched sender identities as suspicious. Investigate the sender, Reply-To address and authentication results before trusting the message.

2. Do not open unexpected email attachments without verification. Check file signatures and actual file types rather than relying only on filenames or MIME declarations.

3. Use secure email gateways and anti-phishing controls to detect spoofed sender addresses, suspicious attachments and malicious links.

4. Investigate and monitor the identified domain, pashter.com, as a potential indicator of compromise. Validate its threat intelligence context before blocking or taking action.

5. Search email logs and endpoint telemetry for other messages or systems associated with the identified sender, Reply-To address, sending IP and domain.

6. Preserve original email files, extracted artefacts, investigation notes, screenshots and SHA-256 hash records for future verification.

5. Evidence and Preservation

The following artefacts were examined during the investigation:

* Original email: A Hope to CoCanDa.eml

* Extracted attachment: PuzzleToCoCanDa_attachment.bin

* Extracted image: DaughtersCrown

* Extracted PDF: GoodJobMajor

* Extracted spreadsheet: Money.xlsx

* Hash manifest: SHA256SUMS.txt

SHA-256 hashes were generated for the investigation files and verified successfully. The hash manifest and supporting investigation records were preserved in the Evidence folder.

6. Investigation Limitations

This investigation was conducted using the evidence supplied in the training scenario.

The investigation does not independently establish the real-world identity or physical location of the suspected actor.

The available evidence does not confirm that the attachment was executed, that a system was compromised, or that pashter.com was actively used as a C&C server. The domain is identified as a probable C&C indicator based on the scenario evidence.

7. Investigation Conclusion

The investigation identified multiple suspicious email characteristics, including a spoofing service, a failed SPF result, a mismatched Reply-To address and an attachment disguised as a PDF.

Analysis of the attachment revealed additional evidence identifying Pestero Negeja, the scenario location and pashter.com as the probable C&C domain.

The investigation successfully examined the supplied artefacts, generated and verified SHA-256 hashes, and documented the findings.

Final Status: Investigation completed.